

66 Vocabulary

66.1 COMMON ENGLISH IDIOMS

She had agreed to make a speech, but at the last minute she **got cold feet**.

get cold feet

[have a sudden loss of confidence]



I was **feeling under the weather** for a few days, but I'm better now.

feel under the weather

[feel unwell]



It's obvious that they're **head over heels** in love with each other.

be head over heels

[be completely and utterly in love with someone]



You're exactly right about Dad. He's so lazy! You've **hit the nail on the head**.

hit the nail on the head

[to describe exactly what is causing a situation or problem]



I've got so much to do. Do you think you can **lend a hand**?

lend a hand

[help someone]



I slept terribly last night! I'm really not **on the ball** today.

be on the ball

[be alert, knowledgeable, or competent]



I **heard on the grapevine** that Marina got the job.

hear something on the grapevine

[hear information or news via gossip or rumor]



I'm really working **against the clock** to submit my essay on time.

be against the clock

[be under time pressure to get something done]



The children won't behave today. They are **a pain in the neck**!

be a pain in the neck

[be a nuisance]



Aziz told his aunt that he'd **keep an eye on** her house while she was away.

keep an eye on

[look after or watch carefully]

